

beneath a mound of skin

sideways.

the world sideways.

one wall, carpet.

the other, lights

gray.

muted.

muffled.

the world tense
in equilibrium.

tense
instability.

i watch

a vertical alarm clock

tick minutes away

from a life

that feels

painted on.

i dreamed of her again.

but i also dreamed of a man
tearing skin-tight masks
off his face,
over and over,

and over,
actions mechanical,
eternal,

sisyphean — each false mask
removed is

only replaced with another.

no face to face the world.